

**SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA
COUNTY OF VENTURA**

Tentative Ruling

**2024CUMC024712: MICHAEL LAZELLE, et al. vs MOUNTAIN VALLEY
HOMEOWNERS ASSN, et al.
09/21/2026 in Department 21
Motion for Protective Order**

Tentative Rulings. Parties and counsel appearing for oral argument should address the tentative decision. Parties may submit on the tentative decision by email, with a copy to all other parties in the matter, to courtroom21@ventura.courts.ca.gov before 8:00 a.m. on the day set for the hearing, with a subject line that includes "SUBMISSION ON TENTATIVE", Case Number, Title and Party. If fewer than all parties submit on the tentative, the hearing will proceed, and the tentative ruling is subject to change. The clerk cannot advise if you should still appear or not. The decision of whether to appear for a hearing is to be made by the parties and their counsel. (Dept. 21 Rules & Procedures, p. 4, § II.I.) If you are the moving party and do not advise the Court that you submit on the tentative, or you do not appear at the hearing, the Court may deny your motion irrespective of the tentative.

Unless stated otherwise at the hearing, if a formal order is required but not signed at the hearing, the prevailing party shall prepare a proposed order and comply with CRC 3.1312 subdivisions (a), (b), (d) and (e). The signed order shall be served on all parties and a proof of service filed with the court. A "notice of ruling" in lieu of this procedure is not authorized.

The following is a statement of the Court's tentative ruling. The Court may adopt, modify or reject the tentative ruling after hearing. The tentative ruling has no legal effect unless and until adopted by the Court.

Motion: Defendants Mountain Valley Homeowners Association and California HOA Solutions, LLC's Motion for Protective Order (*opposed*).

Tentative Ruling:

The Motion by Defendants Mountain Valley Homeowners Association and California HOA Solutions, LLC for Protective Order is GRANTED.

The discovery requests grossly exceed the narrow areas of discovery identified by this court in its July 20, 2026, ruling as legitimate areas of inquiry by way of discovery. Defendants Mountain Valley Homeowners Association and California HOA Solutions, LLC are not required to respond to Plaintiffs' Third Request for Production of Documents (Set Three) served on July 21, 2026.

As previously stated by this Court, Plaintiffs may serve new, appropriately narrowed demands for production of documents that comply with Code of Civil Procedure section 2031.300.

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Defendant's request for a discovery referee is DENIED without prejudice.

Counsel for Defendants to give notice within two (2) court days.